



Quick Bread and Butter Pickle Recipe for Tangy Homemade Flavor

This quick bread and butter pickle recipe delivers that perfect tangy crunch in no time. I love how the mustard seeds and a touch of dill brighten up the flavor. Great for sandwiches or as a zesty snack anytime!



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15 min

PREP



30 min

COOK



45 min

TOTAL



4

SERVINGS



Easy

DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 4 cups thinly sliced cucumbers (about 4 medium cucumbers)
- ☐ 1 medium onion, thinly sliced
- ☐ 1 1/2 cups white vinegar
- ☐ 1 cup granulated sugar
- ☐ 1 tablespoon kosher salt
- ☐ 1 teaspoon mustard seeds
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon celery seeds

- 1/4 teaspoon ground turmeric
- Optional: 1 tablespoon fresh dill, chopped

Instructions

- 1** Start by thinly slicing the cucumbers and onion. The thinner the slices, the quicker they absorb the brine and soften just enough while staying crisp. Use a mandoline if you have one to get even slices. Place the sliced cucumbers and onions in a large bowl and sprinkle with kosher salt. Toss gently and let them sit for about 30 minutes. This step draws out excess moisture, which helps the pickles stay crunchy and prevents them from becoming soggy. After 30 minutes, drain the liquid and rinse the vegetables briefly under cold water to remove excess salt. Drain well and set aside. ⌚ 40
- 2** In a medium saucepan, combine the white vinegar, granulated sugar, mustard seeds, celery seeds, and turmeric. Bring the mixture to a boil over medium-high heat, stirring occasionally to dissolve the sugar. Once boiling, reduce the heat and simmer for 5 minutes to allow the spices to infuse the brine. This hot brine is key to quick pickling because it penetrates the cucumber slices rapidly, infusing them with flavor and preserving their crispness. If you skip this step or rush it, the pickles won't develop their signature tangy flavor as well. ⌚ 10
- 3** Place the drained cucumbers and onions into a clean heatproof jar or bowl. Pour the hot brine over the vegetables, making sure they are completely submerged. Stir gently to distribute the spices evenly. Let the mixture cool to room temperature, then cover and refrigerate for at least 1 hour before serving. The longer they sit, the more flavorful they become, but even after an hour, they're deliciously tangy and crunchy. ⌚ 60
- 4** After the pickles have chilled, taste and add fresh chopped dill if desired. Dill adds a fresh herbal note that complements the sweet and sour flavors beautifully. Stir gently to combine. Store the pickles in the refrigerator and consume within 2 weeks for best texture and flavor. ⌚ 5
- 5** For serving, these bread and butter pickles are fantastic on sandwiches, burgers, or as a tangy side snack. They also pair well with cheese plates or picnic spreads. Because they're quick pickled, they retain a crisp texture that contrasts nicely with rich or creamy foods. ⌚ 0
- 6** If you want to make a larger batch, simply double the ingredients and use a larger jar. Make sure the cucumbers and onions are evenly coated and fully submerged in the brine to ensure even pickling. ⌚ 0
- 7** Avoid using cucumbers that are too large or seedy, as they can become mushy quickly. Pickling cucumbers or Kirby cucumbers work best because they stay firm and absorb flavors well. ⌚ 0

- 8 Make sure to use a non-reactive container like glass or food-safe plastic for pickling. Metal containers can react with the vinegar and alter the flavor negatively.  0
- 9 For best flavor, let the pickles rest overnight in the fridge if you can wait. This resting time allows the flavors to meld and the pickles to become more vibrant and balanced.  480

Chef Tips

Use a mandoline slicer for even cucumber slices

Even slices ensure the brine penetrates uniformly, which leads to consistent texture and flavor in every bite. Uneven slices can cause some pieces to be over-softened while others remain under-flavored.

Don't skip the salting step before pickling

Salting draws out excess water from cucumbers, concentrating their flavor and improving crunch. Skipping this can result in soggy, bland pickles because the vegetables retain too much moisture.

Bring the brine to a full boil before pouring over cucumbers

Boiling dissolves sugar and activates spices, helping flavors infuse quickly and ensuring the pickles develop that classic tangy-sweet profile. Pouring cold brine won't pickle effectively.

Use a non-reactive container like glass for pickling

Metal containers can react with acidic vinegar, causing off-flavors and discoloration. Glass preserves the pickle's true flavor and is easy to clean and sterilize.

Let pickles cool to room temperature before refrigerating

Cooling prevents condensation inside the jar that can dilute the brine and affect pickle texture. It also helps maintain food safety by not raising the fridge temperature.

Add fresh dill only after the brine cools

Heat can destroy delicate dill flavors, so adding it after cooling preserves its bright herbal notes and aroma, enhancing the pickle’s complexity.

☑ Store pickles in the fridge and consume within 2 weeks

Because this is a quick pickle without canning, refrigeration slows bacterial growth and preserves crunch. Over time, pickles will soften and lose their fresh flavor.

Storage & Reheating

☑ Refrigerator

Store pickles in an airtight glass jar in the refrigerator for up to 2 weeks. Flavor intensifies over time, but pickles may soften slightly after the first week. Serve cold or at room temperature.

❄ Freezer

Freezing is not recommended for pickles as it breaks down their texture and causes them to become mushy. For longer storage, consider traditional canning methods.

☑ Reheating

No reheating is needed. Simply remove pickles from the fridge and serve cold or at room temperature. If desired, let sit out for 10-15 minutes to take the chill off.

Nutrition (per serving)

45 kcal
CALORIES

0.5g
PROTEIN

11g
CARBS

0g
FAT

1g
FIBER

650mg
SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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